Safeguarding Policy

PROTECTION OF CHILDREN AND ADULTS POLICY STATEMENT

Name of Place of worship/organisation: LIBERTY CHURCH

The following statement was agreed by the leadership/organisation on: 01/02/2024

- This place of worship/organisation is committed to the safeguarding of children and adults with care and support needs and ensuring their well-being.
- We recognise that we all have a responsibility to help prevent the physical, sexual, psychological, financial and discriminatory abuse and neglect of adults and children at risk of harm and abuse and to report any such abuse that we discover or suspect.
- We recognise the personal dignity and rights of adults and children and will ensure all our policies and procedures will reflect this.
- We believe all adults and children should enjoy and have access to every aspect of the life of the place of worship/organisation.
- We undertake to exercise proper care in the appointment and selection of those who will work with children and adults with care and support needs.
- We believe every child should be valued, safe and happy. We want to make sure that children we have contact with know this and are empowered to tell us if they are experiencing significant harm.

We are committed to:

- Following statutory denominational and specialist guidelines in relation to safeguarding children and adults and will ensure that as a place of worship/organisation all workers will work within the agreed procedure of our safeguarding policy.
- Implementing the requirements of the Disability Discrimination Acts 1995 and 2005, Equality Act 2010 and all other relevant legislation, including the All Wales Child Protection Procedures 2021 and Wales Safeguarding Procedures
- Supporting, resourcing and training all those who undertake this work.
- Ensuring that we are keeping up to date with national and local developments relating to all aspects of safeguarding.

- Ensuring that everyone agrees to abide by these recommendations and the guidelines established by this place of worship/organisation.
- Supporting every adult and child in the place of worship/organisation affected by abuse.

We recognise:

- Children's Social Services has lead responsibility for investigating all allegations or suspicions of abuse where there are concerns about a child. Adult Social Care has lead responsibility for investigating all allegations or suspicions of abuse where there are concerns about an adult with care and support needs.
- Where an allegation suggests that a criminal offence may have been committed then the police should be contacted as a matter of urgency.
- Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility.

We will review this statement and our policy annually.

If you have any concerns for a child or adult, then speak to one of the following who have been approved as safeguarding co-ordinators for this place of worship/organisation.

Safeguarding Team:

GRAHAM SHEPPARD

LOIS HILLIER

LINDA GIBSON (admin)

A copy of this place of worship's/organisation's policy can be seen both here on our website and at Liberty Church office.

Signed by leadership/organisation:

Signed: HEATH VAN STADEN (Lead Elder) Date: 01/02/2024

Signed: GRAHAM SHEPPARD (Trustee) Date: 01/02/2024